The Governor

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The History of Senior Pranks

By Toby Grenier ‘26

Senior pranks have long been a highlight of the spring semester at The Governor’s Academy, combining humor, creativity, and a sense of community. From harmless jokes to elaborate plans, seniors use this tradition to celebrate the close of their time on campus. As Ms. Fitzgerald, a longtime faculty member, explains, “I have been here for 40 years, and there have always been pranks.”

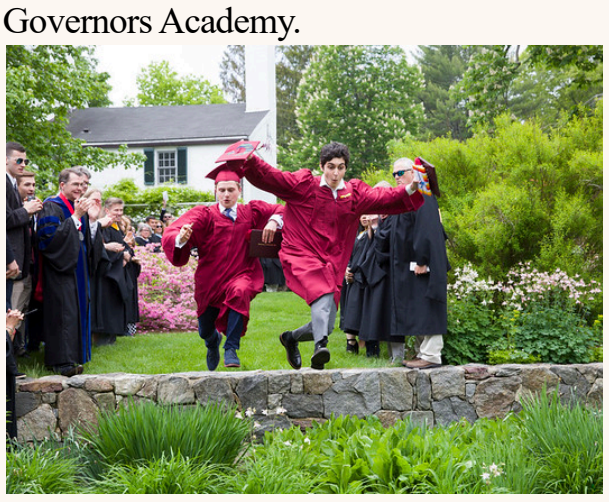
Over the years, some pranks have become especially memorable, standing out for their creativity or humor. Ms. Fitzgerald recalls examples such as hundreds of carefully placed cups covering the entire lobby of Wilkie, forcing anyone who entered to navigate the space slowly and carefully to avoid spilling them. She also remembers students saran wrapping faculty cars, turning an ordinary parking lot into a scene of confusion and laughter. These pranks exemplify the creativity and humor that define the tradition. The most successful pranks are the ones that surprise the community while remaining harmless.

While the tradition of pranks has persisted, the approach has altered. According to Ms. Fitzgerald, “seniors as a whole have become more responsible and less destructive in planning their pranks.” However, she also noted that this can sometimes lead to a lack of creativity, resulting in the repetition of the same prank throughout multiple senior classes. In recent years, for example, many seniors have relied on the same prank of moving backpacks during morning meetings, confusing underclassmen but ultimately creating little lasting impact. This repetition suggests that modern pranks do not always match the originality of earlier efforts.

The administration's response to senior pranks plays a key role in shaping the tradition. Mrs. Fitzgerald alluded to the fact that the school is “usually okay as long as the academic day is not interrupted, the pranks aren't dangerous or destructive, and it doesn't require the maintenance team to clean up.”

The guidelines create clear boundaries for the students to follow, drawing the line between a successful prank and one that goes too far. She emphasizes that, “the seniors need to be responsible and fix whatever has been disturbed,” encouraging students to think carefully about how their actions affect others and themselves.

As this year’s seniors approach graduation, anticipation is already building around what their prank might be. With such a long standing tradition behind them, the pressure is on to create something that is both original and respectful of the school’s expectations. Whichever path they take, it will undoubtedly reflect their legacy as a class and add another chapter to the long story of senior pranks at The Governors Academy.



Govs After Grad

By Ingrid Allen ‘26

Graduation brings excitement, uncertainty, and a sense of freedom for seniors leaving high school. With classes, sports, and exams finally ending, many students are looking towards a freedom-filled summer that will be both a break from school and college preparation. To see what this looks like for the Class of 2026, an anonymous survey was sent out asking seniors to share their post-grad plans. The responses included a little bit of everything, from internships and jobs to travel, rest, and fun.

Some students are planning on taking on internships or career-focused programs. For some, this summer is all about preparing for the future. Internships and training programs are a popular choice for students looking to gain experience before college begins. One senior shared that they are doing an “EMT training course during the week and working at a restaurant on weekends,” while another said, “I’m planning to go to the gym, complete an internship, and get myself prepared for college.” These plans show that even during summer break, many students are still focused on growth and preparation, using their time to build skills, explore interests, and take meaningful steps toward their future careers.

Many seniors are spending part of their summer working, whether it’s for extra cash or just something to do. From restaurants and retail to lifeguarding work, seniors are stepping into all kinds of different jobs.

One student described working at a marina for the third summer, helping with boats and assisting customers. One senior is coming back to Govs over the summer, working with Govs Plus, where she will be teaching classes and mentoring students. One student is planning on caddying, while another plans to work at a boutique in Nantucket. Whether it’s saving money for college or just gaining independence, these jobs are a big part of many students’ summers.

Travel and relaxation are just as important, with students planning trips to other continents, going to concerts, heading to the beach, and spending time with loved ones. People are traveling to a wide variety of places, including Cape Cod, Nantucket, Japan, Florida, Greece, and Italy. One student wrote that they were just planning on sleeping, saying, “Let a man rest.” After four years of hard work at Govs, no one can argue with that. One student even wrote that “I’m going to become homeless exploring the world… then come back at the end of the summer and become a billionaire.” A plan that ambitious definitely captures the spirit of senior summer!

In the end, this summer is all about transition. Whether seniors are working, traveling, interning, or just relaxing, the choices they make reflect not only what they want to do, but who they are becoming. Each plan offers insight into their priorities, ambitions, and personalities at this turning point in their lives. Before everyone heads off in different directions for college, this summer will be a time to make memories, try new things, and enjoy a well-deserved break. Each plan offers insight into their priorities, ambitions, and personalities at this turning point in their lives. Before everyone heads off in different directions for college, this summer will be a time to make memories, try new things, and enjoy a well-deserved break.

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A New Dress Code for an Old School

Editorial by Maxwell Donahue '26, Andrew Melly '26, and Trent DiGiovanni '25

Being the self-proclaimed "oldest continually operated" boarding school in the United States comes with a certain level of prestige and pride. Walking on the same ground that thousands of students and teachers have trodden before carries weight. However, if those same alumni and faculty could see what the school looks like now, they'd be taken aback. The first thing they would notice upon returning would be the dress code.

Should Govs go back to a stricter dress code? From the beginning, Governor Dummer Academy has been an institution based on tradition. When a visitor steps on campus, they see the Red School House, the Milestone, the Mansion House–so many old and distinguished sites. Then they turn and see ripped jeans, leggings, sweatshirts, and pajama pants. The contrast can be jarring.

During Accepted Students Day, we were asked to "dress up"; specifically, no sweatpants. Some in the community were critical because they thought it presented a false sense of what the Govs experience would be to the prospective students.

But perhaps this is how we should look every day so that we can honor the history and beauty of the campus. Looking presentable on a day like Accepted Students Day is crucial because it sends a strong, positive message to the new kids and parents. The way we present ourselves contributes to how others perceive not just individual students, but the entire community. But it can also affect how we see ourselves and our place in the long tradition of GDA.

We sent out a survey asking if Govs should have a stricter dress code or not, and 160 people responded. Overall, 60% said we should keep the current dress code, and 40% wanted something more formal. Of the faculty that responded, 75% of the responses were in favor of a stricter dress code. This survey does not conclusively suggest that we should reinstate a stronger dress code, but it does hint at a desire to consider some changes to the rules we have now.

The dress code has changed many times throughout the long history of the Governor's Academy.

In the past 25 years, however, it has changed more drastically than the 250 years before. The school has replaced tradition with comfort, and we are not better for it. Part of the appeal of prep schools is that they are preppy. When you dress well, you feel good, and that translates to increased confidence inside and outside of the classroom. We should strive to be a school that is better dressed than the eighth graders coming for tours.

Dress Code Timeline

Up through 1971
–All male school.
–Coats and ties required.
–Short haircuts mandatory.
–Formal dress for sit-down dinners.

Coeducation through 2015
–For girls: dresses or collared shirts with skirts or pants.
–Shirts could not show shoulders.
–For boys: slacks (no jeans) with collared shirt and belt.
–No hats allowed inside buildings.
–Struggle with enforcement.

Current Day
–Gender Neutral dress code.
–"Must look presentable," but few other guidelines.

1971: The Beginning of Coeducation at Govs

By Amber Ding '26

In the fall of 1971, 26 female students arrived, marking a milestone start to coeducation at Governor Dummer Academy. What motivated GDA to change from 208 years of history? How did the story of girls at Govs begin?

In Byfield Days by Webster Bull gives us some answers. According to the book, GDA struggled with a growing financial crisis in 1970. Affected by the Vietnam War and the cultural revolution, the school's admission applications had continued to go down. As the situation grew increasingly concerning, the school's board met multiple times to discuss potential solutions, among which included a five-day boarding program, new weekend-off policies, and coeducation.

Initially, coeducation was not a favored proposal. The trustees thought it would lead to extra expenses "the school couldn't afford." Some thought Govs should keep being the "only 100% boys' school." One trustee even suggested "possibilities of a merger with some school such as Pingree." Val Wilkie, the headmaster that year, also believed that "there was no pressing need for coeducation."

Nevertheless, as the financial situation became increasingly strained with admission applications decreasing and income from tuition falling $11,200 short for 1970–1971, meetings were called again. Debates were heated. Finally, the decision to accept girls – but only "girl day students" – was made.

When the girls first arrived, the Boynton House was arranged to be their dressing room, with the second floor's four dorm rooms transitioning into a smoking lounge, a study hall, and two locker rooms. Anne Mackay-Smith '75, looking back at the first few months of school, recalled about the house in 1991: "It was where we went hide. It was hard to be a constant curiosity, and there was a certain amount of pressure. The problem with being a minority – any minority – is that every act becomes emblematic for the entire group." Aside from the difficulties, however, the girls formed an "unusual fellowship" in those first few months, friends and acquaintances being made even between the most different people.

GDA's decision of enrolling girls was relatively rushed and last-minute compared to other schools'. As Dick Leavitt, a long-serving math teacher, pointed out, "St. Paul's used a summer program to experiment with coeducation… We didn't. We just jumped in." Mike Moonves, a former admissions director, also recognized that "we didn't prepare well enough…"

Lack of planning contributed to a lot of difficulties. Problems arose for both faculty, some of which had a hard time trying to adapt, and girls who often felt like "they were second-class citizens." When Peirce first became a girls' dorm, its first floor bathroom still had urinals in it. "The girls were very clever," Leavitt noted, "they put potted plants in the urinals. So, I guess it was trial by fire for all of us – for the girls, for the boys, for the staff."

Indeed, the girls' positive energy and inspiring courage brought about solutions and changes for the better, making GDA – now Govs – the wonderful community it has become.

1…2…3 SWEATSHIRTS

A girls' soccer team played very informally in the fall of 1971.

In the spring of 1972 a girls' lacrosse team was organized, coached by Steven Blair. However, the team's only game was canceled.

Conspiracy Theories at Govs

By Brodie Donovan ‘26

Everyone has heard of the big conspiracies: the moon landing was fake, the earth is flat, and lizards are running the government. The internet is full of conspiracy theories, some more unbelievable than others, and yet they continue to become popular. But the mainstream media is hiding the truth behind conspiracy theories. These secrets go much deeper than the global scale. Much deeper. In fact, Govs students are surrounded by many dark secrets. Here are some global conspiracies that can be seen on the Governor’s campus.

Conspiracy 1: Bigfoot. For decades there have been sightings of a large creature roaming the woods. Scientists have dismissed Bigfoot as a myth, a tall tale, a figment of one's imagination. But still, sightings continue to happen. Lurking deep in the woods of the Alfond Center is a tall figure that no one has been able to identify. Students on their daily walk to Alfond feel a sinister presence. If one ventures alone on the Alfond path at night they can hear the frightening roar of something evil. “I thought it was a person,” said one traumatized senior. “It stood there in the woods staring at me with its red glowing eyes.” Some say it's a hoax. I say The Governors Academy is haunted by Bigfoot!

Conspiracy 2: Weather. You may or may not have heard the allegations that the mastermind behind chemically engineering the weather is none other than Bill Gates. Rumors suggest that he controls the weather to serve his own purposes. Does this sound similar? Who is a high up operative at The Governor’s Academy who manipulates the weather? Just think: in the week leading up to a predicted snow storm in which the students would be given a day off, the weather took a turn for the better. Coincidence? Sources have reported that Dr. Quimby has been spotted standing at a window on stormy days, laughing wildly and looking up into the sky with a satisfied expression.

Conspiracy 3: Secret Society. Around the world, people believe in groups like the Illuminati, full of powerful elites running the world. This might sound like a fairy tale, but Govs has its own secret organization. I should know because I was part of it. One day, standing in the dining hall, I was approached by a senior who handed me a letter saying to come to the chapel for a secret meeting. I didn’t think much about it until I entered the chapel and found a select group of people in costume. I had to offer a sacrifice before I signed my name in a book. But don’t tell anyone because it is a secret!

The Governors Academy isn’t just any ordinary school, it is a utopia of mystery and hidden knowledge. I urge whoever reads this to stay aware of the secrets that lie within the walls of The Governors Academy, because who knows what will happen next…

Do We Need a Sleep In Every Day?

By Adam Krogmeier ‘27

Every morning, students slowly get themselves out of bed before stumbling into the first block at 8:15. For many, this is not laziness, it is biology. This biological miscommunication makes it very difficult for adolescents to perform at their highest ability.

Sleep is one of the most important factors in how well students learn. Teenagers naturally fall asleep later at night and need between eight and ten hours of rest to function properly. This lines up with what science tells us. The CDC states that adolescent brains need 8-10 hours of sleep to undergo a shift in their internal clocks during puberty, pushing their natural sleep and wake cycles later. Asking a teenager to perform complex thinking at 8:15 a.m. is very challenging. When school starts early in the morning, most students simply are not getting enough time for homework, athletics, dinner, and socializing.

A recent survey conducted among students at Gov’s revealed that a majority feel very tired during first blocks (M/Tu/W/F) and feel much better during their Thursday A block, which starts an hour later. Students feel they will be able to be more alert, motivated, and focused later in the day rather than the early morning hours. Many say they regularly arrive at school having slept fewer than seven hours.

Mrs. Kingsbury expressed the difficulties with how the schedule is laid out and how it affects Govs students' academics and afterschool programs. She pointed out that the current schedule does not align with what research shows about teenage sleep needs or the times of day when adolescent brains are most capable of learning. Students are being asked to engage when it neurologically is very difficult to understand and comprehend coursework.

With all the benefits of starting class later, there are factors that halt the deans and others from making this change. Many parents rely on an early start time to fit their own work schedule and a later dismissal could interfere with afterschool activities that require referee availability, maintenance staff, and athletic trainers. With many outside factors affecting this decision, it makes large scale change very hard to implement.

So what could a solution look like? From the survey, many students believe pushing the start time back even fifteen to forty-five minutes could make a meaningful difference. A later start around 8:45-9:15 would allow students to arrive more rested, more focused, and genuinely ready to learn. For Govs, we could shorten PA to only be an hour with a 25 minute lunch or shorten passing time to 5 minutes. Moving everything up in the day by a couple hours would allow for afternoon programs to finish up on time and the evening routine of dinner and study hall to take place. Academic performance, mental health, and student wellbeing are all directly tied to how much sleep students get. If Govs wants its students performing at their best, it may be time to rethink when the day begins.

Pros and Cons of Boarding

By Isabella Gomez ‘26

As a boarding student who lives only 30 minutes away, I used to always consider appealing to switch to day student status. Why move my life somewhere else if I can just commute every day? After four years of sticking it out and serving as a dorm proctor, I can honestly say that I made the right decision. My experience has been mostly positive, though there are benefits to both the boarding and day student experiences.

One difference between boarders and day students is the access to resources on campus. When you are boarding, your life revolves around campus. It is easy to access the library throughout the day and no hassle to meet with teachers after afternoon program. You can even go to the dining hall for a quick snack. There is a good deal of convenience when it comes to being on campus.

On the other hand, Reese ‘26 proposed that though day students might not be as involved at Govs, they get to enjoy a more flexible schedule. “Day students get to go anywhere after their commitments,” she said. Which made me think… day students can escape the chaos that can be right in the center of Govs, including tests, busy schedules, or friend drama. They can spend their time outside of the Byfield bubble, whereas for boarders, it’s more difficult to get off campus.

Another difference between borders and day students is the difference in community. Govs becomes the boarders’ community. They spend most of their time at school during the school year. Whether you are 30 minutes or 15 hours away from home, the connections you make in the dorm and on campus truly mean a lot, with late- night talks, ramen night, and a constant support system. Juliana Lucero ‘26 said, “Coming in as a freshman, the dorm community was one of the greatest support systems I had here.”

However, Reese ‘26 brought up the fact that though you can make a new community at school, you don’t get to interact with your community at home. Some of us have staples in our lives–mainly family–that help us get through day by day. When you are away from those constants, school can be hard. Reese highlighted that going home to her family helps her create stability in her routine.

Besides the challenges and disadvantages, I wouldn't change one thing. The dorm community has become a second home for me, and I’ll forever cherish these four years. Though I haven't had the flexibility to go off campus consistently or see my family as often as I wanted, boarding here at Govs has helped me grow as a person and a leader.

Navigating The Course Selection Process

By Rhoads Kent ‘27

Every spring, students enter one of the most challenging and chaotic times of the year…course selection. What seems like a simple “pick your classes” situation quickly turns into a stressful experience that feels like doing a thousand-piece puzzle. The biggest issue, though, is that no one knows what is going on. These are some of the biggest challenges for students who are navigating the course selection process:

1. **Course Selection Convocation**: There are many problems with this. It happens at 8:15 on a Thursday morning, when no one is awake and able to think about their future. Then all the department heads go up and project a slide which organizes the classes in a way that no one understands. By the time it's over, students leave feeling overwhelmed, overtired, and even more confused than they were before.

2. **The appeal process:** Students scroll through online documents with vague descriptions and extraneous prerequisites. They stumble upon big words like 'Department Placements' and 'appeal,' which might as well mean 'good luck.' At some point, it starts feeling less like course selection and more like a test you didn’t study for.

3. **Your advisor has no idea what is actually going on**: You meet with them and leave feeling confident in your classes, only to question every decision you have made since 6th grade the next minute. Sure…your advisor might, if you're lucky, bring you donuts, but can they tell you about computer science or robotics and give you a suggestion that will actually work? The short answer is… no?

4. **The scheduling conflict**: You think you have just found the perfect class. It's something you're interested in, the teacher is not too hard, and it looks good for college. Then you realize it is actually a semester-long class that doesn’t fit your schedule. Cool.

5. **No APs:** To top it all off, there is the big question: What will APs look like next year? Administrators dance around the word ‘AP,’ phasing in ‘Advanced’ instead, and no one knows what that might mean or when that might happen. For years, AP exams have been long seen as the highest academic honor—challenging and slightly terrifying. With the school now trying to move away from AP classes, students are left with questions about what will replace them and if those classes will carry the same weight.

In the end, the course selection process is about making the best decisions for your future self with the (little) information that you have. Maybe the lesson here is not to build the perfect schedule, but to learn to navigate difficult decisions and accept that sometimes you might have to just throw in the towel and “trust” the process because somehow, it always ends up okay.

The True Crime Elective

By Jason Li 26'

When I was 10, I got my first crime novel for Christmas: Sherlock Holmes. It was a classic: intriguing, sophisticated, and full of twists that a 10-year-old would never expect. The murderers were more than just “bad people”; they had their own tragedies, and their crimes became acts of desperation.

This spring, Ms. Davis started a new elective called “True Crime as Novels.” I got to know this class through Cecileah Wang ‘26, who told me the class is different from her past English classes because “This class isn’t really about analyzing the writing style or the historical period, but more like how the killer thinks in that moment.”

CONTINUED ON PAGE 5

I interviewed Ms. Davis and asked her some questions about the class.

JL: What inspired you to teach this class?

Ms. Davis: I loved true crime myself. I've watched all the HBO and Netflix true crime shows. I've also talked to multiple kids, and they seemed interested in this topic. I thought this class would be a great way to connect true crime with literature.

JL: What is a book you are teaching?

Ms. Davis: The first book I'm teaching is The Fact of a Body: A Murder and a Memoir, which tells the story of Ricky Langley, who murdered a six-year-old boy in Louisiana in 1992. It follows the author's perspective as a law student who wants to fight the death penalty. But as she goes deeper into Langley's case, she realizes she wants him to die, while also exploring her own childhood memory of being abused by her grandfather.

JL: What is something you find interesting about antagonists in these books?

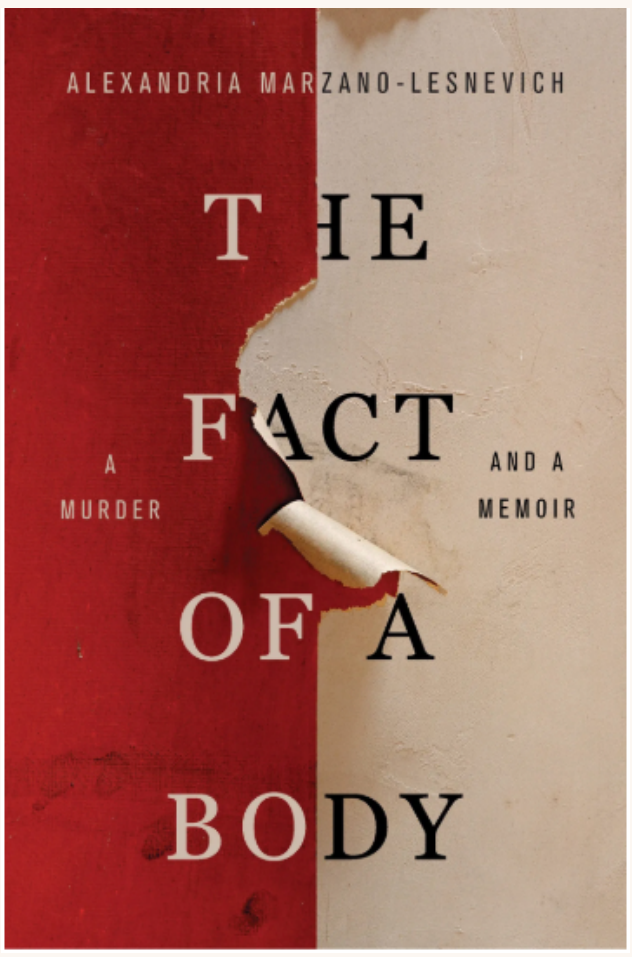
Ms. Davis: One thing I find interesting about these true crime novels is that the antagonists are more relatable than I expected. These serial killers are not simply black and white, good or evil, guilty or innocent. The reason this book is so uncomfortable is that we get the whole story about the murderer. He has a difficult upbringing and serious mental health issues. There are times when he is humanized, and it feels really uncomfortable.

JL: How does point of view in these books impact us as readers?

Ms. Davis: Another thing I think is very interesting about good literature is that the author can manipulate you. The book is written from many perspectives. You move from the crime scene, disgusted by the brutality, to the mom who lost her son, feeling angry and sad. You are drawn to wherever the author wants to take you. The POV of each book or documentary depends on the author or director, and how the story is presented really depends on what they want you to know.

JL: Are you teaching this class again in the future?

Ms. Davis: Definitely. The English department requires us to rotate classes every year, but I will definitely come back to this class in the future.



Life And Soule

Henry Loughman '26

Whether you know him as the guy with the fancy mustache or as your physics teacher, practically everyone has seen Marcus Soule around campus at some point. If you've ever had him for a teacher, you know how loud and light-hearted he is, but for those who haven't, here's all you need to know about him.

Although he never planned to work as an educator, Mr. Soule began teaching early. After a poor test grade on a high school chemistry test, he began tutoring another student as a way to get credit back. He continued tutoring throughout his time studying electrical engineering at the University of Maine, but he didn't fully expect to go into education until after an especially bad engineering internship.

This internship saw him working at a dairy factory with hours so long he had to get a room at the hotel across the street. While the commute was unbeatable, he decided that he didn't want to spend his life working in some soulless, thankless job, so he chose to go into teaching. His first true teaching job began in 2005 at a middle school in Lawrence, Massachusetts.

Shortly after joining Govs in 2015, Mr. Soule created an engineering program to meet the desire of many students. He also began coaching the robotics team, which he continues to lead to this day. As of now, he teaches honors engineering, physics, and, if he is asked nicely, chemistry.

Anyone who has been in one of his classes is well aware of his puns and self deprecating jokes. From absence sheets signed "Jeff McScience" to *Soule*-utions sheets for practice problems, Mr. Soule is great at bringing a smile to the banal affair that school often is. His comedy lights up the classroom every day.

As I can attest, he is loved by nearly all of his students for his patient and engaging methods, kindness, and especially his humor. He is, by far, the teacher I will miss most from Govs next year.

P.S. Don't worry, he'll still be teaching here next year.

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  - Adam Krogmeier '27
  - Vincent Liu '27
  - Alex Hughey '27
  - Rhoads Kent '27
  - Nicholas Zhuo '27
- Teacher:
  - Mr. Robertson

Girls Varsity Lacrosse: A Year of Rebuilding

By: Alex Hughey‘27

Last year, the Govs girls varsity lacrosse team went undefeated in ISL play and advanced to the ISL championship for the second year in a row. Coming off of an impressive season, the question now is whether the team can repeat that success and bring the championship to Byfield.

A defining moment of last season came when we defeated Nobles 13-9 in regular season play, breaking their six-year undefeated streak in the ISL. In a league as prestigious as the ISL, that win made a big statement. However, when we met them again in the ISL championship, Govs fell short, losing 7-9, allowing them to win their third championship in a row. In such a competitive league, matchups like Nobles will demand even greater focus and preparation. We have hopes to redeem ourselves, and beat them this year. Thayer and Tabor also look strong for the season.

Despite last season's success, this year's team looks very different after losing 11 seniors, leaving a very young roster. The roster consists of 20 players, with only three returning seniors, including captain Molly Vana ‘26 (committed to Harvard) and eight returning juniors, including captain Lucy McCormick ‘27.

Although losing key seniors presents challenges, it also creates opportunities for new leaders to step up and for the team to grow stronger together. With many new players stepping into larger roles, one of the team's biggest challenges this season will be learning the intensity and expectations of the program. Beyond skill, success will depend on how quickly our players can adjust to the fast pace, competitive mindset, and high standards that have defined Govs lacrosse. Despite this, Govs lacrosse remains focused on its goals. As Lucy explained, “because we lost so much of our team last year, the plan is to build the team camaraderie and translate that onto the field.” The team’s goal is to make it to the championship game for the third year in a row.

If we continue building the chemistry we've focused on and stay committed to our goals, another championship run is well within reach. This season will ultimately come down to resilience, teamwork, and the ability to rise to the moment.

The Change in the Grill

By Jayden Padilla ‘26

Those of us who are in the student center often have noticed a recent change. Patty MacDonald ran the Grill for many years, serving up sandwiches, burgers, fries, tater tots, and more. Now she is working at Exeter and has been replaced by new staff, but it wasn’t just her food that made her legendary. Patty remembered every student’s name, asked how we were doing, and made a connection with everyone.

Patty was half of the heart of the student center. She and Chris Robinson in the bookstore formed a legendary duo that created a strong connection with the students. Patty always made sure to take a moment to ask about the stresses in the students' day. Even when lines stretched across the entire room between classes, she was always calm and attentive. Patty had a rare mix of efficiency and intentional care. Walking away from the counter left you with more than just a meal; you left with joy knowing that the food you have been given has been made with love.

The food that Patty made was amazing. My own morning routine was to show up every day to order two bacon, egg, and cheeses; eventually she had them waiting for me the moment I arrived, wrapped in foil to keep the heat in. Each sandwich was top quality crispy bacon, fried eggs, and perfectly melted cheese between toasted plain bagels. Paired with an Arizona iced tea with lemon from Chris at the bookstore, there was no better way to start the day. Now that Patty has moved on, the difference is obvious. The student center is quieter, emptier. The loud, crowded energy is gone, and the new grill workers have big shoes to fill. Seniors especially lost that daily constant of seeing Patty and starting their day with that familiar spark. Students still talk about her and miss the impact she had.

It wasn’t just food it was the connection, the routine, the way she brought smiles to everyone.

Change is not always easy. This isn't the same Govs it was five years ago. The grill may not feel the same right now and that's okay. Now it's up to the new workers and the students to make new memories and new routines. Over time, the student center can feel alive again in a new way.

THE GOVERNORS GRILL

How To Get Through Junior Year

By Vincent Liu ‘27

Junior year at Govs is like the first day of learning how to swim – an inevitable, painful, but also rewarding experience. Thesis paper is coming, harder classes are waiting, and college application is looming, making junior year indeed a challenging year. Ms. Allen, from the learning center, has some useful tips to conquer this difficult year.

One thing that Ms. Allen emphasized was to find “hidden time” – times we often wasted scrolling or hanging out with friends. Although staying with friends is good for mental health, the correct approach is to “treat it as a reward rather than a way to procrastinate.” “When things start piling up,” Ms. Allen mentioned, “we all know how stressed we get.”

Another thing Ms. Allen brought up was to learn from failure. “We never learn how to deal with the times when we are disappointed in ourselves without learning from some minor failures.” She gave the instance that if students did badly on a test, it could be an opportunity to learn better test-taking skills. Be resilient; don’t let failure compound itself to make a bigger failure.

Finally, Ms. Allen suggests prioritizing a free block in junior’s schedules. A free block has two benefits: it gives you more time to catch up on work, and it helps you to exercise your time management skills. In college, students will have fewer class times and more free time.

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Having a free block familiarizes you with college life earlier, and you will become better at using your free time wisely.

In addition, here are some of my personal perspectives that might be helpful:

1. **Perfectionism is often detrimental**. Don't set too many goals and try to achieve every one of them. Know your priorities, which might be your grades or sport, and put most of the effort into that.
2. **Having a good mood boosts your productivity.** Getting some sunlight, staying hydrated, and eating enough usually makes the mood better. Most importantly, don't be afraid to talk to your friends, parents, and the counselors at the health center when you are having an especially bad week.
3. **Be honest about how much sleep you need**. Only a few people can sustain themselves with very little sleep. Sacrificing sleep often compromises efficiency, ending up worsening the results compared to getting enough sleep. Try not to drink coffee after 3 PM. Caffeine could stay in your body and hurt your sleep quality.

Getting through junior year not only requires better time management but also better mood, lifestyle, and mindset management. Believe me: the start is always the hardest. The further you progress into the year, the better you get. Good luck to all of you!

A Brand New Dining Hall

By Tyler Passo '26

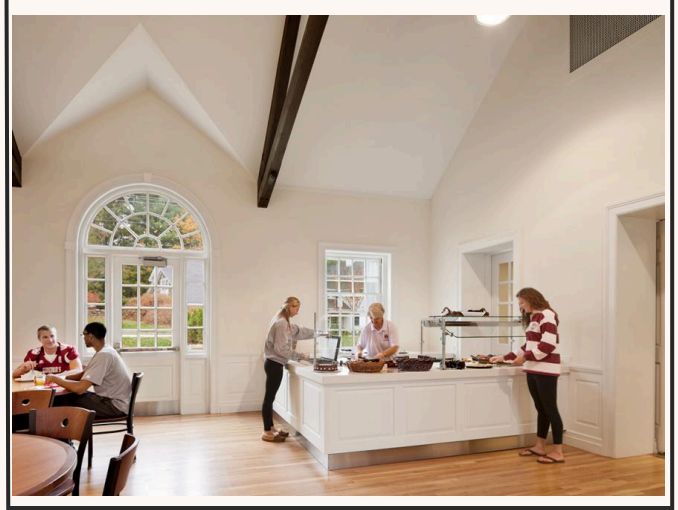
As everybody eased back into school life the Tuesday after spring break, students were shocked to notice that their beloved dining hall had some new and improved components. The dining hall staff was hard at work over spring break making many new changes to the recipes, dining materials, layout, and much more.

For starters, the layout for the buffet area changed, making it feel more like a five star hotel breakfast area. Instead of having the traditional silverware holder, there is now a fancy counter where the silverware sits in black baskets. There are also new plates to serve the pizza and new cookers to hold the rice. Near the area where the burgers and hotdogs are served, there are heat lamps that keep the food warm and fresh. Overall, the new changes provide easier maneuverability through the servery area to help people get their food quicker.

When you head into the dining area, you will see plenty of new aspects as well. For starters, the cereal area had a complete overhaul, changing the cereal dispensers and the different kinds of cereals. The dining hall staff also added an area where you can get peanut butter, jelly, butter, cream cheese, and bagels. And finally, there are now plastic cups that hold a little more liquid and prevent glass shattering.

The response to the new changes has been mostly ambivalent. Jason '26 says he "Likes the new changes because all of the nicer dispensers and bottles help prevent mess on the floor and on clothes as well." Vincent '27 feels that a lot of food options have been cut, including the special protein options provided by the burgers and chicken. He also thinks that the portions of food have become smaller.

Overall, the new changes to the dining hall have impacted the Govs community by making the dining experience better.



AI as a Crutch vs. a Tool: Preserving Human Agency

By Nicholas Zhuo '27

Academic help was once a dictionary, a friend, or office hours. Now it's a machine that thinks for you… AI can finish your sentence, rewrite a paragraph, and produce a full argument in seconds. For students, the development of AI has challenged us to consider what role it should play in our education. If it can do the work for us, then what should we be focusing on?

Artificial Intelligence can be effective as a tool after you've figured out your direction, but it becomes a crutch when you use it to choose the direction for you. When AI provides the claim, the reasoning, and the voice simultaneously, critical thinking is lost.

The ethical standard for AI use is human authorship.

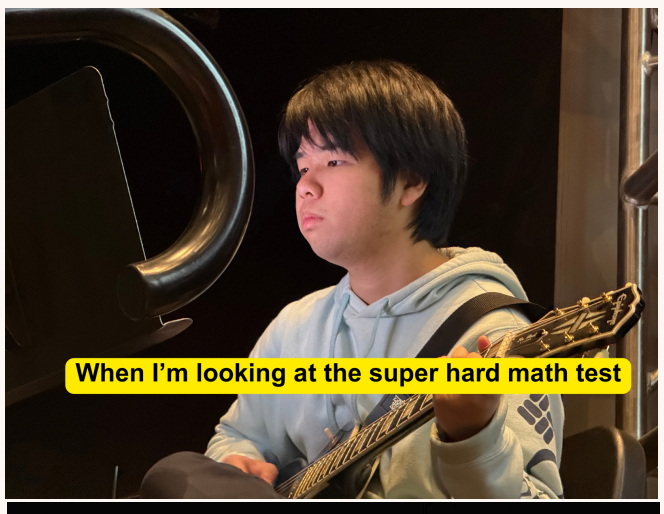
When juniors write their history thesis, they make several intellectual decisions: choosing the question, framing the claim, and selecting the evidence. They take full responsibility for mistakes because the thinking is theirs. AI undermines authorship when people ask for "the answer" and submit the gathered information instantly and directly, which hands over the process and authority for crafting their response.

Education is supposed to build capacity, not just produce output; it's more than content transfer. Students build judgment through crafting mental models and applying them. They apply their models in school, learn from and refine them based on teacher feedback, and use them to thrive in real-world settings. When one reaches for AI before building that internal model, they skip this developmental work. AI creates a polished page, but you don't practice the process of producing it.

Schools face a structural problem: students adopt AI quickly, but many classrooms still grade products over. This mismatch rewards exactly the crutch behavior teachers want to discourage. The better response to this "crutch-boom" is structural change, not surveillance. Teachers could grade outlines, drafts, and revisions rather than just final pages.

Classes can add in-class checkpoints or graded discussions with impromptu prompts that reward real thinking. These changes will make authorship easier to practice and harder to fake.

An AI-rich world will not reward whoever writes fastest; instead, it will reward the ability to judge. It will reward those with the ability to say, here is what I think, here is why, and here is what would change my mind. You can be successful with the facilitation tool of AI, but only if you refuse its most tempting offer: the crutch.



spring sports

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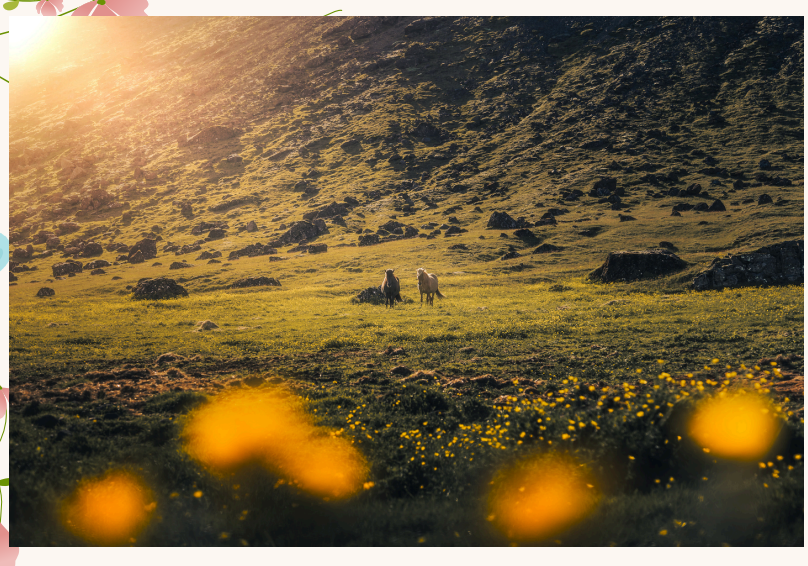
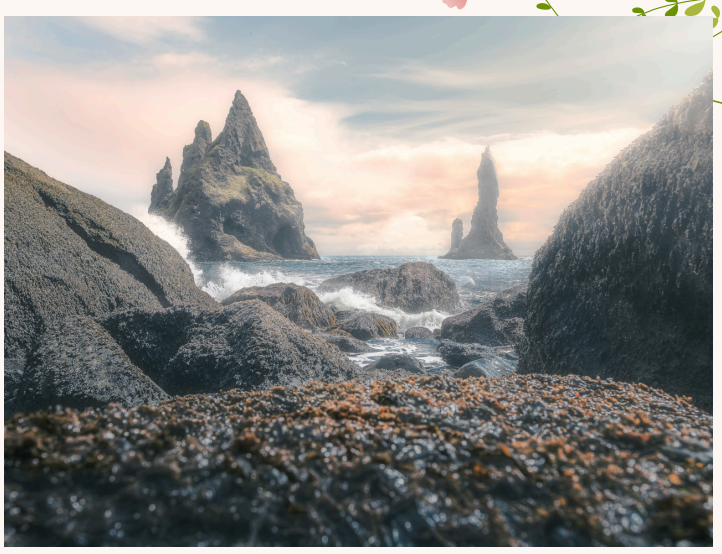
CAPTAIN
LACROSSE
BALLS
TENNIS
STICK
MITT
MOUND
BASEBALL
RACKET
GOAL
RUNNING
HOMERUN
SOFTBALL
DISTANCE
RELAY
LONG JUMP
TRACK

Art and Nature





Photography by Alex Wang '27

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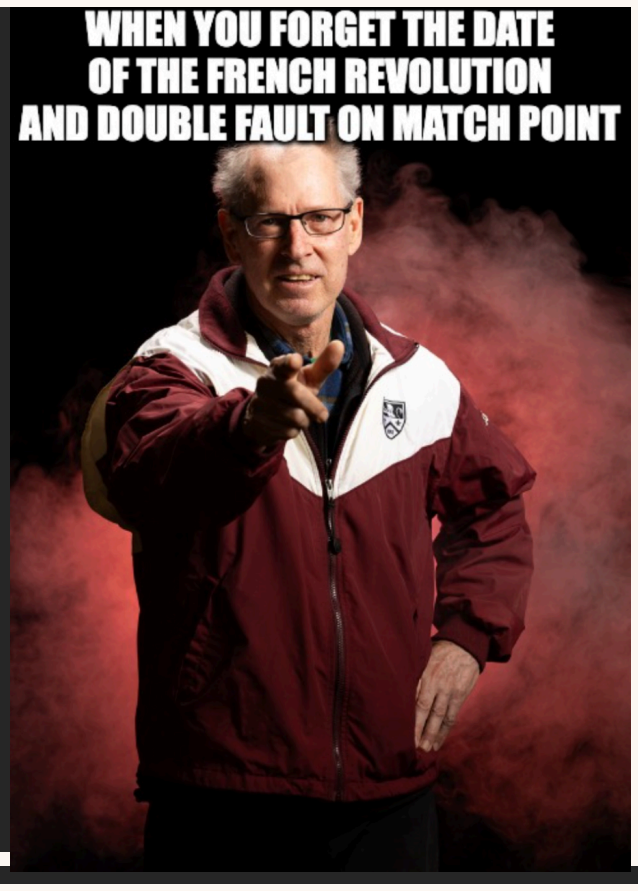

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